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Accident Is the First Building Block of Evolution



In *Interstellar*, upon finding Miller's planet sterile, Amelia Brand argues for going next to a planet very far from Gargantua, Edmunds' planet, instead of the closer Mann's planet: "Accident is the first building block of evolution," she tells Cooper. "But when you're orbiting a black hole, not enough can happen—it sucks in asteroids and comets, other events that would otherwise reach you. We need to go further afield."

This is one of the few spots in *Interstellar* where the characters get the science wrong. Christopher Nolan knew that Brand's argument was wrong, but he chose to retain these lines from Jonah's draft of the screenplay. No scientist has perfect judgment.

Although Gargantua tries to suck asteroids and comets into itself, and planets and stars and small black holes too, it rarely succeeds.